



medical profession, Doc remained accessible and fun-loving. After he moved from Kolkata to Mumbai, there were more occasions for us to meet. The chemistry he shared with Leander was not confined to the tennis court — he was always on hand to guide and mentor his son through life's challenges.

While I used to meet Doc off and on, I had not met Leander since he had embarked on his quest for excellence. Then, a decade and a half ago, an exhibition football match in Mumbai saw Leander and me in the same team. I was meeting him after many years and post his meteoric career.

I was relieved that he remembered me! In fact, I was disarmed by his humility and genuineness. Over the years, I have met him more often and observed that he is

**Deep mind:** Doc Paes became the face of sports medicine in India. His deep knowledge enabled him to add scientific temper to training, fitness, and recovery.

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a chip off the old block — charming and extremely respectful to people from every walk of life. Precisely the values that endeared Doc Paes to one and all. I am thankful to him for giving India a world champion in Leander and instilling in him a strong set of values. And just as importantly, grateful for his immense contribution to Indian sport in a multitude of ways.

*M. M. Somaya was a member of India's gold medal-winning hockey team at the 1980 Moscow Olympics and later captained the side at the 1988 Seoul Games.*